

Gradient descent, Morty!

Where "the gradient pointing in the right direction" has taken Team FourSight · 30 Sep 2026

Rick sees the landscape. The Mortys feel the slope.

15 Sep · proposal

initial scope:
replay April
trip by trip

Wubba lubba
dub dub!*

portal restart

29 Sep · plan v2:
restart on the new landscape

28 Sep · the valley vanished:
the trip-level data never came

3 What's in plain sight
that we can't see

unsampled: a saddle, or the global minimum?
Only Rick can see this far.

2 Regimes + the calendar
(side-branch)

event-aware forecast of
load and slowdowns,
scored each new month

Apr 17: the system slowed
(opening night of the 150th
All-Alumni Weekend)

YOU ARE HERE · 30 Sep



4 Mortys = Team FourSight

Aw geez, Rick...
which valley?

1 Simulation + dispatch
(our project)

synthetic nights consistent
with the aggregates; five
dispatchers on identical nights

the value ladder
N · A · B · C · H
pooling · waiting ·
coordination · information

L(θ): how hard the answer is to defend
defensible Cronenberg territory

"...the gradient pointing in
the right direction." *burp*



Rick = Prof. A. J. Kearsley
sees the landscape

one step along $-\nabla L$
digitized · mined · G1 passed

*Birdperson's translation: "I am in great pain, please help me." Said by every data scientist whose data got yanked.

θ: our design choices. Every path is a true gradient flow of the L drawn here. No Mortys were harmed.